Getting Started: Make an API Call

Ready to extract some data from the API? To get you started, this tutorial will guide you through the process of making your first call (API request). You will access the GitPrime API from Postman (a REST client), and then pass in (specify) an object and a parameter. We'll start with a simple yet very real-world scenario of requesting a subset of author records.

First, let's make sure you have the prerequisites squared away:

- Do you have an active GitPrime account and login credentials? If not, send an email to Support.
- Do you have at least one repository that contains data that you have permission to view? As a test, see if you can access any of the GitPrime reports. If you cannot see the reports, your ability to access meaningful data via the API will be limited.
- Do you have API permissions? This allows you to access the API directly from our website. In the Authentication section, we show you how to create an API key so you can fetch data without having to be logged in GitPrime. For now, let's just get some data Log into GitPrime, click your avatar, and select **User Management**. Click your name, and then scroll down to the **Api-access section**. Make sure at least one of the APIs listed has a check next to it. If not, contact your system administrator.

All set? Let's get started!

1. In Postman, enter your API URL. In this example we'll use: https://app.gitprime.com/v3/customer/core/authors/?limit=3
2. Click the **Send** button.
3. This should return the first three AUTHORS in your account. Note the Status: 200 OK.

That's it. Congratulations, you did it!

This is a very simple example of a request you can make in the GitPrime API. Advanced features that allow you to customize your results are also available.

Supported HTTP Methods

The GitPrime API provides read-only access to the objects, which means only GET requests are supported at this time.

Response Object

The response object contains the following information:

- **Count –** The total number of records available in the record set
- **Next** – The net URL in a pagination sequence; null If at the end
- **Previous** – The previous URL in a pagination sequence; null if at the beginning
- **Results** – The data of the request

Count, Next, and Previous are used for paginating large result sets describe below. However, all your action is in the results field.

Let's break down the URL. It's pretty straightforward.

Request URL

The request URL is a string representing the URL of the request. The URL syntax looks like this:

> **Request URL**
>
> https://app.gitprime.com/v3/customer/core/authors/?limit=3

[protocol]:// [hostname] [api version] [customer/core] [object] [parameter(s)]

Where:

- **Protocol** is the network protocol used to make the request: For security reasons, requests to the GitPrime API must always use the **https** protocol.
- **Hostname** is the IP address or URL for the GitPrime application. If you're using an on-premise version of GitPrime, this will be something other than **app.gitprime.com**.
- **API Version** refers to the version of the API being accessed.
- **/customer/core** will always be the same.
- **Object** is the resource in the GitPrime API from which you want to extract data. Examples are AUTHORS, COMMITS, and TARGETS. See Customer API for the complete list.
- **Parameter(s)** are the filters you use to extract a specific result, such as an Id, or a query parameter to restrict the result to a specific set of data. Parameter passing follows the widely used **?key=value&** pattern.

Supported HTTP Response Codes

The GitPrime API supports standard HTTP response codes.

Code	Description
200	**Success**. The request was successful. The results are displayed in the response body.
400	**Bad Request.** The request was unsuccessful. The problem is usually tied to incorrect request input. Error details are displayed in the response Body.
404	**Not Found.** The results are empty. No data matched your request.
500	**Internal Server Error.** The GitPrime system experienced an unexpected error. The problem has an unknown cause.

Supported Date and Datetime Formats

The GitPrime API supports ISO format date and datetimes.

For example:

2018-06-25 or **2018-06-25T00:00:00**

API Permissions

GitPrime provides object-level permissions.

Note that only Owners on a GitPrime account have access to manage API keys. You must grant any non-owner permissions to manage API keys. An example would be to give permission to a team lead to be able to distribute additional API keys for various integration projects.

In general, we recommend you create an API service account rather than mapping the API to an individual. Typically, you name that service account something generic like API_SERVICE_ACCOUNT.

View Rights and the API

View Rights are a key feature in GitPrime to control the depth of information a user can see in our interface. To learn more about View Rights in general, visit the Help Center.

However, View rights are completely bypassed in the API. This is by design. View Rights are report-dependent. The API is based on primitive objects, not reports. This is important to understand as it has serious security and information access implications. If you give a person access to the COMMITS object in the API, for example, they will have complete unrestricted access to that object. That means they will be able to see any commit in any team in any repo.

If you wish to restrict or control that access, you must enforce it at the client level. This is in part why we strongly recommend you use a service account.

Assign API Permissions

1. Click the avatar, located in the bottom-left of the screen, and then select **User Management** from the list that is displayed.
2. Select a user link. The user panel opens. An example of an existing user panel is shown in the following image: